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DirectXion



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Digital

Passion

Fuelling the pursuit of technology knowledge

Lead Feature

God Mode

Create a generic first-person shooter using FPS Creator, then rip it apart and make it your own

Nimish Chandiramani

There are few things that excite the lazy geek, and quite close to the top of that list is the ability to create programs without having to go through the tedium of actually learning a programming language. For those who have ever wanted to make their own game without having to deal with the (many) intricacies of game programming, FPS Creator is a godsend. It makes creating your own first-person shooter (FPS) a simple matter of drag-and-drop—draw environments, place enemies and weapons, and start playing!

You'll find the demo of FPS Creator on this month's DVD—it lets you test games, but not make standalone EXEs out of them. The full version is a remarkably reasonable \$49.99 (Rs 2,300), and lets you create standalone EXE files for your games, and even sell them royalty-

free. The system requirements aren't too heavy—most half-decent PCs should be able to handle FPS Creator and its games.

Starting out with FPS Creator is quite easy, and the manual it comes with is quite comprehensive and more than enough to help get your first game off the ground.

One drawback, of course, is that all the games you create will end up looking factory-made—the same sounds, similar textures, same old AI—and if you've used the program even once, you can easily tell whether a game was made using FPS Creator (FPSC). If you want your game to be unique, you'll need to brave the dark underworld of AI scripts and 3D models. Read on for what you need, but remember—you're not going to create the next *F.E.A.R.* anytime soon with FPSC, and certainly not without serious programming skills.

Finally, we advise that you keep FPS Creator open while you read this.

Illustration Pravin Warhokar
Photograph Amrut Pataki

